

NATHANIEL SALAZAR

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OBJECTIVE

Computer Science student concentrating in cybersecurity (network security and ethical hacking) with hands-on experience investigating and exploiting real vulnerabilities through Hack The Box, CTF competitions, and virtual SOC clinics, alongside full-stack development experience (Python, Django, Flask). Skilled in vulnerability enumeration, exploit analysis, and turning investigation findings into working tools. Seeking a cybersecurity/threat analyst role to apply investigative rigor and technical depth to real-world threat detection.

EDUCATION

The University of Texas Rio Grande Valley (UTRGV) Expected Dec 2026

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — Overall GPA: 3.69

Relevant Coursework: Digital Forensics, Networks, Database Design and Implementation, Software Engineering

The University of Texas Pan American (UTPA) Dec 2011

Bachelor of Fine Art in Graphic Design

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages & Querying:** Python, SQL, C++ (introductory), Bash
- **Security Tools:** Kali Linux, Wireshark, Scapy, ffuf, linPEAS, xfreerdp, Nmap
- **Security Concepts:** MITRE ATT&CK, vulnerability enumeration & exploitation, privilege escalation, CVE analysis, SQL injection, XSS, JWT exploitation, cryptographic attacks (RSA, XOR, AES-CFB, AES-CTR)
- **Platforms:** GitHub, Microsoft Azure (VM deployment), Virtual Security Operations Center (VSOC), Django, Flask
- **Certifications:** Google Cybersecurity Certificate, First Aid, CPR/AED
- **Languages:** Fluent in English and Spanish

SECURITY LABS & CTF INVESTIGATIONS

Hack The Box — user “viznate”

- **Sequel:** Enumerated and exploited a MariaDB/SQL misconfiguration to gain initial access
- **Cap:** Escalated privileges by identifying a misconfigured Python binary capability, using linPEAS for enumeration
- **Fireflow:** Identified and chained Langflow CVEs (CVE-2026-33017, CVE-2026-5027) into working exploits, using ffuf for subdomain enumeration and vhost routing analysis
- **Explosion:** Gained remote access via RDP (xfreerdp) after enumerating exposed services

Competitive CTF — 2nd Place

- Solved challenges across forensics, reverse engineering, cryptography (RSA, XOR, AES-CFB/CTR attacks), and web exploitation (SQL injection, XSS, JWT bypass) under time pressure

EXPERIENCE

Sedgwick — Remote Senior Care Team Representative Dec 2024 – Present

- Managed 100+ high-stress customer interactions daily, de-escalating 90% of conflicts without further escalation
- Resolved 99% of weekly customer complaints, achieving a 96% CSAT score and contributing to a 95% improvement in customer retention metrics

AT&T — Sales Associate | Edinburg, TX Sep 2022 – Dec 2024

- Managed \$1,200+ in daily cash transactions, maintaining a 100% accurate cash drawer for 36 consecutive months
- Educated 10+ customers daily on devices and service plans, achieving a 59% upsell conversion rate; recognized as a top performer for exceeding goals by 30% for 5 consecutive quarters

UTRGV — Emergency Communications Operator | Edinburg, TX Apr 2016 – Dec 2022

- Implemented a new 4-person team handoff process, reducing shift transition errors by 99%
- Managed an average of 60 emergency and non-emergency calls per shift, including coordination during 8 large-scale campus events with high-profile visitors
- Maintained operational readiness through 45+ hours of annual training; held TCOLE and EMD certifications

PROJECTS

MiDerechoApp — 2nd Place, Frontera Hacks 2026Spring 2026

devpost.com/software/miderechoapp

- Built a bilingual (English/Spanish) React Native/Expo mobile app, integrating the Claude API to help workers understand their FMLA rights

IDS — Intrusion Detection SystemSpring 2025

github.com/viznate/ids-flask-sniffer

- Built a Python-based IDS using Scapy and Flask to detect and visualize real-time port scan activity • Built a browser dashboard with auto-refreshing, color-coded alerts and external IP flagging
- Deployed and tested across local and cloud (Azure VM) environments as a scalable foundation for further security tooling

Study Group FinderSpring 2026

github.com/UTRGV-3340/group-project-ts26-03-04

- Developed a full-stack study session app (Django) with authentication, role-based admin access, and RSVP functionality • Implemented 40+ test files spanning unit, integration, pytest, and BDD layers to validate models, views, forms, and access control
- Built relational data models (User, StudySession, RSVP) with Django ORM, including cascade deletion and duplicate-entry prevention

ACTIVITIES & ACHIEVEMENTS

VISI Cybersecurity Club, Member | Edinburg, TXSpring 2025 – Present

- Provide hands-on vulnerability triage for local businesses through cyber clinics using a Virtual Security Operations Center (VSOC)
- Weekly briefings on emerging threats and common vulnerabilities and how to remediate them

DoD Cyber Sentinel Challenge, ParticipantJuly 2025

- Placed 333rd of 2,015 participants in this Department of Defense cybersecurity competition

UTRGV Cybersecurity Competition for Engineers WeekSpring 2026

- Placed 1st on the “Crack RSA” challenge

DSAA — Data Structures and Algorithms Architects, Member | Edinburg, TXSpring 2024 – Present •

Weekly coding practice and discussion of common problem-solving patterns to build interview readiness

Frontera Devs, Member | Edinburg, TXSpring 2024 – Present

- Participated in sustainability-focused hackathons; built a site showcasing recycling centers across the Rio Grande Valley

RGV Cyber, Member | Edinburg, TXSpring 2025 – Present

- Weekly discussions on cybersecurity topics including reverse engineering and Python scripting

Raices Cyber, Member | Edinburg, TXSpring 2025 – Present

- Attend online talks with cybersecurity professionals on skills and certifications